Pitcher Comparison

SABR Level One | Daniel Hedrick

I believe this choice is definitely a bit tougher than the hitter comparison, regardless I am going to be going with Pitcher A.

Once again starting with baseline knowledge because when you are in player acquisition mode, obviously you cannot ignore those. Pitcher A is still on the right side of 30 and in 3 out of the 4 seasons, he has made at least 30 starts. I don't really have to worry about durability here for either player, so it seems you didn't give me Tyler Glasnow (only kidding). I won't beat around the bush, player A is obviously outperforming his predictive stats by a solid margin, yet, he still seems to be outperforming player B in this margin as well recently. You now have a 60+ start sample size where player A has the edge in FIP, SIERA, xFIP. That is potentially worrying for a pitcher entering his age 35 season with presumably, already a lot of innings on his arm. It also seems as if Player B's swing and miss stuff has dipped year after year, despite throwing almost the same exact amount of innings in the prior two seasons, obviously explaining an uptick in a few of those predictive stats. This only tells me that he is going to continue to regress until he is no longer a major league caliber pitcher.

I think what you have here is a guy in player A, who is maybe predominantly a groundball/pitch to contact player, and that is all he ever has been, and all he ever will be. Whereas with player A you can tell even by that age 31 season with 207 Ks, almost a 5 fWAR, 2.92 FIP, etc he probably used to be a frontline ace with great stuff. Granted, I will admit I am saying this already knowing who this player is, but the stats tell the story here. Prime vs prime I am 100% taking player B, but if you are asking me who I would rather have right now, it is player A without a second thought. The only scenario where I'd take player B is if he drank the "Justin Verlander career revival juice" that he had in Houston.

Comp Spreadsheet - Pitcher Comparison Data - Module 14.xlsx

Comparison Data

Source: SABR course comparison spreadsheet, supplied with the evaluation. Ages represent the four seasons shown for each player.

Player A

Age	ERA	GS	IP	HR	BB	K
26	2.13	30	190	15	44	170
27	3.03	24	139.2	17	40	123
28	3.44	33	199	22	44	161
29	3.46	30	177	19	32	150

Age	WHIP	ERA+	FIP	SIERA	xFIP	fWAR
26	0.979	196	3.2	3.7	3.59	4.2
27	1.189	145	3.88	4.08	3.76	2.5
28	1.146	121	3.78	4.03	3.87	3.4
29	1.13	127	3.61	4.38	4.26	4.1

Player B

Age	ERA	GS	IP	HR	BB	K
31	3.34	32	205	16	47	207
32	2.44	32	202.2	21	52	197
33	4.33	32	180.2	26	60	180
34	3.32	32	181.2	24	64	149

Age	WHIP	ERA+	FIP	SIERA	xFIP	fWAR
31	1.122	114	2.92	3.19	3.06	4.9
32	1.016	171	3.41	3.61	3.47	4.2
33	1.323	101	4.1	4.07	3.85	2.9
34	1.31	125	4.39	4.57	4.43	1.8